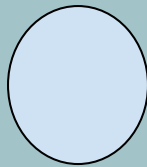

THREADS OF BECOMING

Poems on Life, Growth, and Struggle

By Joel Kaudzu



Preface

This poetry collection comes from the heart and mind of Joel Kaudzu, a young poet and student who has experienced life's ups and downs in a very real way. These poems tell stories of struggle, hope, faith, and growth. They explore moments when life feels hard, when friendships fade, or when the world seems unfair—but also the moments of light, courage, and self-discovery.

The poems are grouped into sections that take the reader on a journey: from personal challenges to reflections on society, from questions about life to the infinite possibilities of thought. Each poem is a small window into Joel's experiences and the lessons he has learned along the way.

Through his words, Joel invites readers to feel, reflect, and find meaning in their own lives. This collection is honest, thoughtful, and full of hope—a story of a young person learning, growing, and discovering the beauty in life's challenges.

About the Author

Joel Kaudzu is a premed dental surgery student at Kamuzu University of Health Sciences, a poet, an innovator, and a lifelong learner. From an early age, Joel has been curious, disciplined, and reflective, constantly exploring the world around him and seeking to understand life on a deeper level.

His journey has not been without struggle. During secondary school, Joel experienced a period of intense self-consciousness and social anxiety. Friends misunderstood his situation, and this deeply affected him. Once a confident extrovert, Joel began withdrawing from social situations, avoiding crowds, and even hesitating to attend religious meetings. Yet, in this period of isolation, he discovered resilience, introspection, and a powerful desire for personal growth.

Despite these challenges, Joel never allowed adversity to define him. He invested in himself outside of formal schooling, devouring books about business, exploring the stock market, and learning new skills. He began building connections, seeking mentorship, and understanding people, family, and the place of God in life. His creativity and innovative mindset led him to experiment with technology, eventually developing his first app, CheckMySmile, and pursuing graphic designing projects to express ideas visually.

Joel's time at KUHES has been a transformative experience. Initially, he underestimated the demands of university life, thinking that passing MSCE meant he could easily navigate college. However, he soon realized that success requires more than IQ: it demands commitment, time management, consistent effort, and spiritual grounding. Through his first semester, Joel experienced the balance of freedom, struggle, learning, and growth, while understanding the importance of humility and grace in every achievement.

Through poetry, Joel channels his deepest emotions, reflections, and observations about life, society, and the human condition. His work explores pain, perseverance, hope, innovation, and the infinite thoughts that shape our experiences. Each poem reflects his personal journey, offering readers insight into both the challenges he has faced and the resilience he has cultivated.

Beyond academia and writing, Joel is passionate about connecting with others, learning from diverse experiences, and making a positive impact through innovation and

creativity. Mentors and peers, such as Joshua, have played significant roles in shaping his spiritual and personal growth, guiding him toward deeper understanding and meaningful action.

Joel's story is one of perseverance, creativity, and self-discovery. From battling insecurities and social pressures to embracing technology, innovation, and poetry, he continues to learn, adapt, and create. His journey is a testament to the power of resilience, reflection, and faith, inspiring others to embrace their vulnerabilities, pursue their passions, and navigate life with courage, integrity, and vision

Table of contents

Table of contents.....	4
BROKEN AND BECOMING.....	5
PARADOXICAL.....	5
MY PAST I'M SORRY.....	7
LOST GOLD.....	10
SO IM HERE.....	13
The Boy Who Almost Gave Up.....	15
LIGHT THROUGH THE STORM.....	20
MY TIME WAS COMING.....	20
THE LIGHT IN THE DARK.....	22
FRACTURED LIGHT.....	23
THERE'S OKAY IN BARELY OKAY.....	26
INFINITE THOUGHTS.....	30
INFINIVERSE.....	30
WHAT If.....	33
IF BIRTH HAD ANESTHESIA.....	36
SOCIETY AND REALITY CHECK.....	38
WE'RE ALL CIRCUMCISED.....	38

BROKEN AND BECOMING

Before something becomes, it must break. The cracks let in light, the fractures tell the story. This section is not about endings, but about the trembling birth of new strength.

PARADOXICAL

Too much of a good thing they say,

Can be harmful in some way,

Of course it seems to pave way

But when does it become too much?

How do we know when to stop and clutch?

It's easy to be swept up in excess,

To be poisoned by success

To lose sight of what really makes us blessed.

The more we have, the less we see

But why?

The harder we try the more we cry

We've tried so hard with all our might

But somehow things never turn out right

The harder we push the more we fail

Our efforts seem to be in vain and pale

Like secondary school porridge bitter and stale

But maybe there's a lesson to be learned

That sometimes when you try too hard, you'll burn

Perhaps it's best to take a step back

Some achievements are way beyond luck

To change the world they say you must Accept the way it is

And trust that what you resist,Persists with force

But what you embrace can bring remorse.

To make things different first accept them as they are

Then change will come from near or far

Don't fight against the things you hate

But rather learn from them to appreciate

MY PAST I'M SORRY

First Let me say sorry I failed you
Like a plane those promises just flew
bad i could not achieve even a few
I said I will make you rememberable
But I can not dare reminisce about you
All my words dearly were true
But some obstacles in life are just too true

My past im sorry
Sorry for being a bad Steward
I vowed to tame you well
It's pretty clear on that I fell
The little hope I gave you,all shattered
Those efforts I gathered,all scattered
The path I chose was a mistake
Please forgive me for Gods sake

I'm blank of what went wrong
I thought I had set everything straight

All being alright seemed fate

It was late when I realised,

My choice was my bad mate

Sorry I failed you

All that aside

Allow me to make a mends

I know I can't undo the already done

But I can create new memories,ask me how?

I'm looking at your brother,MY FUTURE

I think he might be a second chance

For now I have my balance

Learnt it the hard way

It is the time to do it God's way

I take an oath my past

I swear I'll make your brother,my future,the best thing that has ever happened to me

This time my success is inevitable

For I have my all clinging to this oath

Just like soot to a clay pot

A shoe and a lace

I will win this race

Against all odds I shall prevail

Surely I am not going to fail

I have my eyes sharpened

Things happened

But it's time to let go

Again, my past I'm sorry

LOST GOLD

Hey friend,

I know we're not in good terms

Our bond like dying flames

But you're still my good friend

True we drifted apart

Mine for you is still a heavy heart

We've come way from far

Walked on dusty roads and tar

You were always my companion

And I never lost compassion

Our friendship did not cease

Selfish, I let it freeze

I know it's hard we go back

It's just your presence that I lack

Take your time and think about it

I thought of the good old days a bit

Yes I realised

Your face from my life,I failed to erase

Your memories keep receding

The gaps I fail to keep feeding

I Hope we are not beyond repair

I don't think this emptiness I can bare

You know several times I pleaded

But it's seemed the elastic limit was already exceeded

Now we are not even common

Maybe just the skin tone

But our architectures changed

like spades and jacks

No turning back?

I'd still give it another go

In fact,all the go's in the world

Wherever you are,feel longed for

Sincerely, the boy with the eyes four

SO I'M HERE

I look up I look down

Faces staring, it's like I should drown

I turn left and turn right

Happy faces, and there's me in fright

So I'm here

A 20 Hour drive ends here

To A destination frosted in fear

Hopes shattered, reality builds

Sought confidence, self slavery yielded

A place in dreams so envisioned

Sadly ,to the dungeon I was commissioned

Pain,pain,pain

Let it rain rain rain

So I'm here

Is this what it's become

I thought the journey to life began

Time stopped a while ago

Infinitely stuck in a smoked Canva

Was it life? No. I see myself a cadaver

The Boy Who Almost Gave Up

There was a boy who used to laugh with his whole chest.

He believed in God. He believed in family.

He believed he was made for something more.

But life hit him.

First, it showed up in his skin ,a rash, small and annoying.

Then it came in disappointment,results that didn't match his prayers.

Then silence ,people stopped checking in.

Then doubt, "Am I really who I thought I was?"

And slowly, piece by piece, he started disappearing inside.

He was still smiling. Still showing up. Still quoting verses.

But in private?

He felt weak. Forgotten. Unseen.

He didn't hate God

but he wondered if God had stepped back.

He felt like the golden child who lost his shine.

Even his own reflection started to feel like a stranger.

And no one saw.

Not his friends who told him to man up.

Not his parents who didn't know how much he was hurting.

Not even the church that once clapped for his potential.

But God saw.

One night, in the middle of one of those God, I'm tired moments

He whispered something to himself

I don't even know who I am anymore

And for the first time in a long time, he didn't feel alone.

No lightning. No angels singing.

Just stillness, peace and a deep voice in his spirit:

You are not your skin.

You are not your results.

You are not the shame you carry.

You are my son.

And I have not changed my mind about you

He broke. He cried

not because he was weak

but because he was still alive.

And somehow, that was proof that God hadn't left.

He didn't bounce back overnight.

But he got up the next morning and he started again.

He wrote down goals.

He deleted things that were stealing his peace.

He stopped shrinking himself to fit in.

He let go of some people.

He kept praying even when it felt dry.

He found God in the silence, not just the fire.

He wasn't hiding anymore.

Not from God.

Not from life.

Not from himself.

Now, he's becoming a man with vision.

He protects his mind.

He watches what he posts.

He treats his life like a brand, valuable, strategic, intentional.

He doesn't chase swag.

He builds legacy.

He prays before he plans.

He worships even when he's confused.

He asks God for wisdom like it's oxygen.

He builds his life on spirit, not on flesh.

He still battles urges.

He still gets tempted to give up.

But now he knows, God isn't after perfection

He's after progress.

And progress means showing up, even with shaky hands.

He used to think pain disqualified him

But now he knows, pain made him ready

He thought he was lost.

But he was only buried.

And now he's growing.

So if you ever see him smiling, worshiping, or dreaming again
just know, this is the boy who almost gave up
but didn't.

And now, he is becoming the man God always knew he'd be.

Living life not out of decree

Embracing the beauty of living, wild and free

Alas, alas

He is heading there

With shoes on or feet rooted bare

Young and strong or grayed hair

Freedom is the goal still

LIGHT THROUGH THE STORM

Even in shadowed corners, light finds a way to seep through. In moments that feel small, fragile, or fleeting, hope always whispers. These poems trace the gentle glimmers of resilience, the sparks that remind us: we can breathe again, even after the storm.

MY TIME WAS COMING

For the stars to appear it has to be dark

I cry each time I look back

I recall the times I used to wear a sack

For all the necessities I used to lack

That's a time of unspoken bad luck

So sad in that state for long i was stuck

Even my only relative turned his back

My thumbs so dirty I could not even suck

Little did I know

My time was coming

Though at that time I lacked smiles

I tried my best to walk uncountable miles

In that journey of life for a long while

For the road was not as smooth as a tile

But rather rough as a file

Indeed I had to fight

My time was coming

My betterment was what I fought for

I had to use my long horn

Many Surprised today I've won

Free as an electron

For sure

my time was coming

Now look at what my labour has brought

It has indeed brought a lot

A future worth calling a fruit

True it wasn't an easy route

The seeds took way long to sprout

But the harvests were worth it

I just had to believe

My time was coming

THE LIGHT IN THE DARK

Through the stormy nights you were his shelter,

A beacon of hope when his foundation was weak

Your words gave him courage when he felt like giving up,

He found strength to rise up and his spirit perked up

You lifted his head when when he was bowed down in despair

Your light shone bright,And gave him hope to repair,

You noticed him when all he felt was disregarded,

Your compassion was medicine,for his emotional infection,

And when the emotions became chaotic

your support was catalytic through your reckless love

His heart was heavy, his spirit Broken

But you were there to raise him up

He felt casted aside and you saw his value

Wonderful merciful saviour ,that is you

FRACTURED LIGHT

The fear of letdown gives us no reason to try again
The people we trust are the ones who make it rain
The level of constant disappointments burdens us
Leaving us fed up, exhausted, and deeply burnt

The last resort becomes a loner's trend
From the dark trenches of the deep seas
To the silent sheds of the Amazon trees
A life spent on scavenging peace
And never does the urge to, ever seize

Solitude seems to guarantee
It gives us freedom, like genie to Aladdin
We think we've found it, and it was meant to be
But for how long does it last?
A present life burdened by the past
Memories inprinted like childhood scars
Satisfaction only enjoyed from the stars

It's a painful truth that no matter the comfort We enjoy in our loner's zone

One day or another, we will feel alone

That is why we need people, real people

It's not bad luck that we encounter bad companions

It's just a reminder that not every shoulder,Is a leaning beacon

Be patient with your life, and keep your eyes open

If you're keen enough, you'll see one

Pure hearted, loving,supportive, shiny, and golden

It's that single encounter that changes the story

A new chapter, new pages, new setting and new characters

All in the same book,by the same narrator, YOU

The only limitation is that the past story

Can never resurface

But the new one has a milestone of pages to cover

Anything can happen, it's just up to the author

No man is an island

Keep your heart open

Don't be afraid

No matter the countless loops

A rollercoaster makes,

it'll still end up where it started then, the ground

You were born happy

You'll end up happy

THERE'S OKAY IN BARELY OKAY

I still remember it vividly

It was a bright Sunday afternoon

The Sky was sunny ,clearer and blue

Boredom struck me to the core

I was so lonely and craved for more

So I decided to visit an old friend of mine

Since contact had been a really long time

The longing for connection I couldn't overlook

There was no stopping me, that taxi I had to book

When I arrived the rain was dropping

A stern face with her eye brows dropping

I asked her what's wrong and she said she was in heart break

Her boyfriend had dumped her and her life was a train wreck

I sat quiet and didn't know what to say

I understood her pain but it wasn't worth the tear stray

Momental scars that could heal in a day

I told her to kneel and together we should pray

Before I departed I had to ask

"This is the last time that I'm gonna ask"

"How are you" she said barely okay

Then I said,

At least there's an okay in barely okay

I missed him ,sad we had to meet in that way

My uncle,that had long been gone for years

Always dreamt he'd come and buy me a new bike

Before he bought it,his life was on spikes

The car he boarded to work overturned

Soon as I heard the news my heart burned

I wished I could help him,my hand I could lend

But he had Many bone fractures the doctors had to mend

Time flew fast and his recovery was quick

The moment he woke up he said he felt weak

to his surprise he couldn't feel his leg

A shouting stutter "where's my leg gone i beg"

He sobbed and sobbed and sat on the corner

If only he knew the length of his coma

I felt his loss , but gratitude was solace

At least on his own , foodstuffs he could forage

I asked him how are you he said barely okay

Then I said you know what,

In that theatre, someone is not even barely okay

A frustrated face behind the stage on that Christmas night

A few minutes before he performed that pluck

The strings of the guitar got tangled and stuck

He feared for his reputation

For an awful performance was what he never had

It was the First day I saw the tears of a guitarist

From heartwarming melodies to the face of wist

But I comforted him, my hand on his wrist

A disheartened man behind a melody starving mist

There was no other way

He needed to save it for another day

Broken I knew otherwise he couldn't play

I asked him man how are you he said barely okay

I said you know what?

At least there's an okay in barely okay

So my friends, please take heart
Limitless are the desires of the heart
I understand we intermittently grieve our loss
But isn't happiness what matters the most?
A bird in hand is worth two in the bush
Why do you weep about an unsung flute
One's life out there has just been put on mute
Let's learn to find joy in the simplest of things
True, human beings are complex beings
But Never let that ever make you feel weak
There's an okay in barely okay

INFINITE THOUGHTS

There are thoughts that stretch beyond the boundaries of language...drifting like stars across the mind's horizon,whispering of love, loss, and the quiet wars within.This section is a constellation of such fragments,where infinity is not measured in numbers,but in the weight of questions that never end.These poems are the echoes of the universe when it dares to speak through a human heart

INFINIVERSE

In the infiniverse, where stars are born

And galaxies stretch beyond what's sworn

I find myself, a soul adrift

Yearning for the infinite, my heart's rift

Continuous echoes tuned by the joyful vocals

Pitched from the stretching of my Adam's apple

The light I see, not stained by a single bit of shade

In this resonance, I find my way

Through the infiniverse, night and day

A path unwinding, like a river's flow

Leading me to secrets, yet unknown

Feeling contented with peace, I proudly show
From my head to the tip of my toe
No defined pattern, both columns and rows
The scent of freedom, the fragrance of rose

In this state of bliss, I find my voice
A melody that echoes, a heartfelt choice
To dance with the universe, wild and free
Embracing the beauty, that's meant to be

No death, just immortal beings
Blood nor pain, everyone sees
Clear vision, all keenest of sight
Free of sin, but moral delight

In this realm of wonder, we roam and play
Where love and wisdom guide us, every step of the way
With hearts full of kindness, and minds full of light
We dance through eternity, in pure delight

In wisdom and faith, we surely strive

Accumulators of spiritual will, our souls they drive

Bubbles of weakness and desperation

We remove the recess with amalgamation

Prayers solid and virtual, no apparition

All is real, see the mirror of redemption

WHAT If

What if I died today

Breath seizure comes my way

blood my heart no longer relays.

Will I face God?

Will I look God in the eyes confidently

And say lord I've done your will

stood stiff as a quill

On your ways I was still

All this time I've been real

That I prayed and skipped at least a meal

All for you my lord

Will I?

Its a misfortune

Failing to comply with his rules

Masqueraded in fake love and sympathy

Nothing good behind just jeopardy.

clung to Living a life of fallacy

Prayers loud,sins masked ,pride in redundancy

You have it all, you're rich

You fast,days pass,baptised and you even preach

But what if you're cleanliness denied, poor in spirit

The gate opens to those in merit

There is no better time

Let's prepare ourselves

There is no better path

Path to everlasting life

The only glamour to Walk in eternal light

Against all the battles lined up for you, God will fight.

Unfortunately,we lack sight at most

When it's salvation,It comes at a cost

It's not jewellery, mansions, prestiged vehicles nor coins

Pity won't buy it, neither will wealth.

Only the size of a mustard seed of Faith

Let's emulate him

Be rimmed by his kind

Be fenced by his words .

We know for wild animals he raids

Are we not more precious than birds

Don't we fear hell?

A place with a story, scary to tell

Just a step forward is all it takes

Freedom and peace is what it makes

A hurdle free life isn't guaranteed

But breakthrough and persevering strength is indeed

With each passing day the invite is open

It's nothing fancy, honor and it is not modern

But at the end of it all you'll be okay

It is God's way

IF BIRTH HAD ANESTHESIA

Ever wondered?

If birth had anesthesia

Would it have a meaning?

If labour bore no pain

Would it be fulfilling? No

Some say pain marks the convenience of the being to come

The essence and soulful nature of that specific period of time

Word taking time right?

Negligible stings during birth

How would we even describe it

The divine creator had a reason

Metaphors in his words on this they reason

But what if birth had anesthesia

Would the value of a child even be appreciated

Would the existence alone be anything precious

We strive for eternal freedom

But would it be worth it

A word with no pain nor suffering

Salvation and liberty forever shimmering

Imagine how pain shapes a person

The determination and perseverance it instills

The purposeful life it creates

The goals and system It helps one set and build

Isn't it worth it

Wouldn't we miss that

A world without pain implies a world without boundaries

Where all life lies on the same meniscus

No high nor lower class

No worker no employee

ever wondered?

SOCIETY AND REALITY CHECK

*This section stares at the world we live in..its masks, its wounds, its strange traditions.
The poems here question what we've accepted as normal, and expose the silent truths
society often hides*

WE'RE ALL CIRCUMCISED

We're all circumcised

In the midst of these jovial faces broken hearts lie

Among these agile hands and feet rests unbearable bitter pie

Tell me how are we not circumcised?

The pain and disappointments on our heads

The freedom we yearn for,worth priceless beads

We're all circumcised

Tell me who doesn't bare the weight of the evil doings of these greedy politicians

Unfulfilled promises piercing through our skins

In their eyes were just little weaklings

Puppets to be used for deeds of their likings

How are we not circumcised

The sensation we endure like surgery without anesthesia

So sad such moments always linger

We're all circumcised

We spend over half our lives grappling knowledge in school

All to secure high paying jobs and look cool

But belated success never loosens from our skin

Like juicy sutures and gauze clinging together

Hurt feeling and thoughts seem forever

We're all circumcised

One source's capital to start a business

Humble beginnings his hands can witness

but then taxes seem to be the weakness

Setbacks sharp as the theatre scalpels

Between profits and taxes we have to tackle

Hell Caesar

We're all circumcised

An innocent young lady can't access a job without offering her body as sacrifice

She's nothing else than mere merchandise

You hear the boss say there's a price to pay

To get the spot on her he must lay

How are we not circumcised

They tell an intern to have 10 years experience so he can sit on the chair

How can a person's heart be polluted as air

Swollen eyes like day two of circumcision

The torture overflows with no restrictions

We're all circumcised

Tell me why do decisions made by the leaders only impact the poor citizens

You decline peaceful agreements In the comfort of your offices

Yet the effects of the atomic bombs and missiles are felt by the innocents

How are we not circumcised

Lost hope aching and burning in our hearts like iodine

Resentment we can't digest like ptyalin

Grinding hard for the final aesthetic prospective

Or so we think

We're all circumcised

What crime do people born with the defective melanin gene commit

They can't even go jog to stay fit

Fearing the hungry predators of their own species

Confined like astronauts in space suits

Caught up in circles of freedom pursuit

The able enter DAPP stores to sweep of the remaining cheap clothes

Leaving the high priced ones for the poor

Tears from our eyes never cease to pour

We're all circumcised

Who hasn't felt the excruciating pain of this world

We can't even pronounce the word

That describes what we're going through

Or whatever we're about to

It's clear we might need another set of eyes

These two are burdened by a stream of tears they failed to handle

The peace we once enjoyed now we just mumble

Upon paradisiacal life we stumble

By now everyone has realised

Truly, we're all circumcised

CLOSING THOUGHTS

To those who shaped my journey — my friends, family, mentors, and God — this collection is a tribute to your support and presence.

Jeremiah 29:11 — “For I know the plans I have for you, declares the Lord, plans to prosper you and not to harm you, plans to give you hope and a future.”

